

SAMIPA KHANAL

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

- A Scrum Master/Associate Project Manager with 8+ years of experience leading cross-functional teams in Agile frameworks like Scrum, Kanban, and SAFe, consistently delivering high-impact projects.
- Proven ability to foster collaboration, continuous improvement, and innovation by effectively managing complex projects, dependencies, and stakeholder communication to ensure successful project outcomes.
- Demonstrated ability to empower teams, optimize performance, and drive value delivery across diverse industries, leveraging skills in project planning, risk mitigation, and resource allocation to achieve strategic objectives.

SKILLS

- **Frameworks & Methodologies:** Scrum, Kanban, Scrumban, SAFe, TDD, BDD, PI Planning & Execution, Agile Release Train (ART) Management, Lean Portfolio Management, Theory of Constraints
- **Practices & Tools:** Scrum Ceremonies (Daily Scrum, Sprint Planning, Sprint Review and Sprint Retrospectives), Product Backlog Management, Scrum of Scrums, Inspect and Adapt, Agile Coaching, MS Project, Jira, Confluence, Azure DevOps, SharePoint, Power BI, Burn-down/Burn-up Charts, Cumulative Flow Diagrams
- **Team Management:** Servant Leadership, Cross-Functional and Offshore Team Management, Mentoring & Coaching, Conflict Resolution, Stakeholder Management, Facilitation, Empowerment, Transparency, Core Protocols, Core Commitments, Emotional Intelligence
- **Project Management:** Project Planning, Roadmap Development, Project Charter, Contingency Planning, Business and IT Alignment, Change Management, Risk Assessment and Mitigation, Communication Management, Scope Management, Cost Management, Schedule Management, Quality Management
- **Business and Data Analysis:** Requirement Gathering, Impact Analysis, Process Mapping, User Story Mapping, Data Catalog, Data Governance & Compliance, Elicitation Techniques, Documentation and Specification
- **Process Improvement:** Continuous Improvement, Velocity & Capacity Calculations, Lead time and Cycle time, Prioritization (MoSCoW, WSFJ, Ranking and Voting), Estimation Techniques (Planning Poker, T-shirt Sizing, Story Points, Relative Estimation), KPIs, Actionable Agile Analytics, Problem Solving, Root Cause Analysis

CERTIFICATIONS

- **Certified Scrum Master** - International Scrum Institute
- **Certified SAFe 5 Advanced Scrum Master** - Scaled Agile Framework (SAFe)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Scrum Master
The Dow Chemical Company

Aug 2022– Present
Midland, MI

Project Summary: The Dow Data and Analytics Project established an Integrated Data Hub and implemented an Enterprise Data Catalog to enhance data accessibility and governance, resulting in improved data-driven decision-making and streamlined data discovery across Dow. The AI Enablement project enhanced operational efficiency in Dow's Steam Cracking Furnaces by generating risk alerts, detecting coking issues, and producing 3D visualizations for advanced analytics. These initiatives collectively improved data management, operational efficiency, and decision-making capabilities within Dow.

- Facilitated and optimized Program Increment (PI) Planning sessions, ensuring alignment with organizational priorities and commitment to achievable objectives.
- Collaborated with the Project Management Office to develop Program Increment Objectives, track progress, and ensure alignment with business goals throughout the increment.

- Proactively managed dependencies across teams, ensuring identification, tracking, and resolution before and during Program Increment Planning.
- Coordinated with offshore teams, ensuring seamless communication and coordination across time zones to align with delivery timelines and objectives.
- Drove continuous improvement by conducting Inspect and Adapt sessions to identify bottlenecks, risks, and actionable improvements.
- Monitored KPIs to ensure team outputs aligned with business and strategic goals.
- Facilitated cross-team collaboration by promoting and organizing synchronization meetings to align delivery efforts.
- Engaged with senior leadership, providing Program Increment reports and status updates, ensuring visibility into progress and delivery challenges.
- Managed capacity planning, ensuring sustainable team velocity and optimizing resource allocation across sprints and Program Increments.
- Proactively engaged in risk mitigation by maintaining a transparent RAID log (Risks, Actions, Issues, and Decisions) across projects and programs.

Environment: SAFe, Azure DevOps, Microsoft Purview, SharePoint, SAP BW, Hana, Power Automate, Azure Data Lake Storage (ADLS), Azure Synapse Analytics, Databricks, Service Now, Power BI

Scrum Master

State of Maine, Department of Education

May 2021 – Aug 2022

Augusta, ME

Project Summary: This project involves supporting the NEO Data Reporting System, an Operational Data Store (ODS) that consolidates data from twenty functional modules submitted by Maine schools and districts. The system serves as a central data collection platform, producing reports by integrating with other departmental systems to generate State and Federal reports. These reports support state subsidy calculations, inform legislative policies, and enable schools and districts to make data-driven decisions regarding programs, curriculum needs, and resource allocation.

- Led two cross-functional Agile teams, utilizing Behavior-Driven Development (BDD) to improve collaboration and testing and ensure alignment with user needs.
- Implemented Agile Coaching practices, fostering a culture of quality, efficiency, and continuous improvement within the teams.
- Managed the work intake process, ensuring that work items were refined with stakeholder input before backlog development, contributing to efficient project initiation.
- Promoted Core Commitments and Core Protocols, established working agreements and communication plan improving collaboration and reducing silos across remote teams.
- Guided the team in updating and following Definition of Ready (DoR) and Definition of Done (DoD) documents, ensuring adherence throughout development and contributing to consistent quality.
- Tracked work progress using Actionable Agile Analytics (AAA), retrieving data, writing queries, and generating reports for stakeholders and Product Owners, enabling data-driven decision-making.
- Facilitated the team's transition from sprint-based delivery to a continuous flow process, leveraging metrics like lead time, cycle time, and throughput to optimize delivery.
- Proactively managed and resolved conflicts within and between teams, coordinating with stakeholders to negotiate solutions and maintain a collaborative environment.
- Facilitated Scrum ceremonies, including Sprint Planning, Daily Scrums, Sprint Reviews, and Sprint Retrospectives, using creative techniques (Sailboat, Election Manifesto, Mad-Sad-Glad) to engage the team and foster continuous improvement.
- Managed, prioritized, and tracked the product backlog, encouraging the proper use of Azure DevOps to collect meaningful data and improve team efficiency.

Environment: Scrum, Scrumban, Behavior Driven Development (BDD), Azure DevOps, .Net framework, Actionable Agile Analytics (AAA), SQL server database, SSRS, SSIS

Project Summary: This project aimed to implement a centralized data warehouse system, consolidating historical and real-time customer data to gain insights into customer spending patterns, ensure real-time inventory tracking, and deliver tailored promotions. This initiative improved customer satisfaction, increased cross-selling opportunities and enhanced operational efficiency by leveraging predictive analytics to optimize the in-store shopping experience.

- Led and coached Agile teams, ensuring alignment with Scrum, Kanban, and SAFe practices, promoting transparency, collaboration, and continuous learning.
- Collaborated with the Release Train Engineer (RTE) to align Program Increment (PI) planning objectives with iteration goals and ensure on-time delivery.
- Managed all aspects of PI Planning, including backlog refinement, dependency identification, and feature alignment with business value streams, utilizing estimation techniques for accurate sizing and forecasting.
- Facilitated Scrum ceremonies (Sprint Planning, Daily Standups, Reviews, Retrospectives, Scrum of Scrums), driving continuous improvement and cross-team alignment.
- Promoted Lean Portfolio Management practices to ensure work aligned with strategic objectives and delivered measurable value.
- Created and maintained team working agreements and assisted Product Owners in defining product roadmaps, managing backlogs, and prioritizing features.
- Tracked team progress using various metrics (burn-down charts, cycle time, throughout, lead time, CFDs, velocity) to provide actionable insights to stakeholders.
- Participated in Inspect and Adapt workshops and Scrum of Scrums to identify and address bottlenecks, manage dependencies, and drive improvements across the Agile Release Train (ART), while proactively engaging in risk mitigation efforts.

Environment: SAFe, Jira, SharePoint, Salesforce, Azure SQL database, Azure Data Factory, Databricks, Azure SQL Datawarehouse (Synapse Analytics), MS Project, Power BI

Project Summary: This project was about implementing an Omni-Channel Marketing Strategy to ensure consistent messaging across e-commerce channels. By leveraging frequency capping and business rules, the project improved funnel conversion, customer satisfaction, and loyalty. Personalized interactions across channels aligned with customer preferences, and complete customer journeys were mapped to gather performance insights for continuous optimization.

- Coached the team on Agile principles and best practices, ensuring adherence to the framework and fostering continuous improvement.
- Collaborated with the Product Owner to define the product roadmap, minimum viable product (MVP), and key release features.
- Developed the project framework, including the release schedule and sprint plan, and facilitated Sprint Planning and story estimation sessions.
- Led all Scrum ceremonies, including Daily Stand-ups, Sprint Reviews, and Sprint Retrospectives, using effective techniques to encourage team participation.
- Identified and resolved team impediments and roadblocks, while promoting cross-functional collaboration and knowledge transfer.

Environment: Scrum, Jira, Confluence, Salesforce, MySQL, Oracle

Project Summary: The project involved the implementation of SAP S/4 HANA Finance, upgrading from SAP ERP 6.0 to a cloud-based system using brownfield methodology. This upgrade streamlined revenue collection, payment reconciliation, and receivable management through automation, consolidating payments from multiple sources into a unified system.

- Elicited and documented detailed business requirements, translating complex needs into actionable deliverables and user stories with clear acceptance criteria.
- Collaborated with stakeholders and SMEs to conduct process mapping and user story mapping, ensuring a comprehensive understanding of workflows and user needs.
- Assisted in setting up the Scrum team and led knowledge transfer sessions, fostering a collaborative environment and ensuring team members understood Agile principles and project goals.
- Supported the Product Owner in backlog grooming, prioritization, and roadmap development, ensuring alignment with business objectives and value delivery.
- Contributed to project management activities by participating in Scrum ceremonies, monitoring progress, identifying and resolving impediments, and promoting communication and collaboration among team members and stakeholders.

Environment: Waterfall/Scrum hybrid, Rally, SAP Migration Cockpit, IBM-Infosphere Information Server, Salesforce, SOAPUI, SAP Fiori, SAP S/4 Hana Finance, SAP Hana, Oracle

EDUCATION

- **Masters in Business Administration** (Information Technology), Campbellsville University, KY - 2024
- **Masters in Information Technology Service Management**, Campbellsville University, KY - 2023
- **Masters in Global Media and Communication Studies**, University of Bridgeport, CT - 2020
- **Bachelors in Media and Communication Studies**, Tribhuvan University, Kathmandu - 2017